

Maxfield Allison

Infrastructure Engineer · Alabaster, Alabama

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Infrastructure engineer who owns a multi-region enterprise Azure platform by day and operates a production-grade Kubernetes homelab by night. Ten years customer-facing across enterprise accounts, now as the single global escalation point and named application owner. I work fast by directing AI agents while owning the architecture, standards, and integration myself. Everything ships through linting, tests, and review.

Experience

Senior Specialist, Technical Account Support

June 2024 - Present

Ricoh USA, Inc. · Customer Engineering Services

- Global owner of an enterprise output-management platform on Azure, serving thousands of devices across four global regions; single global escalation point.
- Cut platform-related support ticket volume 38% year over year, measured in the customer's ServiceNow, by stabilizing the operating model and driving process and self-service adoption.
- Architected a production-mirrored non-production environment and am building it out: made the business case to leadership, won the funding, and defined the design, sizing and resource specification across three organizations, delegating provisioning to the platform teams through ServiceNow change and request workflows (CHG / RITM / SCTASK).
- Identified and drove correction of configuration faults in cloud firewall and microsegmentation layers owned by other teams and vendors, including one degrading DNS for the platform globally.
- Named application owner with approval authority over production changes on the platform.
- Contributed to the architecture decisions for the on-premises to Azure migration and the geo-redundancy re-architecture.
- Verified a vendor and partner consolidation of a large Windows print-server estate onto Azure VMs, catching and correcting errors during the rollout.
- Identified the GPO scoping requirement in the TLS 1.0/1.1 and legacy LDAP remediation and owned the IIS and application-layer changes; automated internal certificate renewal.
- Authored the platform's canonical backup and recovery runbook, now used company-wide for major-incident response.
- Top-tier customer survey scores with personal recognition; contributed to a five-year contract renewal.

Specialist II, Technical Account Support

February 2020 - June 2024

Ricoh USA, Inc.

- Implemented and managed advanced output-management solutions for education, healthcare, and multinational corporate clients.
- Led a security enhancement for a large healthcare institution, updating several thousand devices across multiple sites and applications to SNMP v3.
- Led migration of an on-premises output environment to an Azure-backed platform for a large enterprise client, consolidating dozens of Windows print servers into a fraction of the footprint on Azure VMs.
- Authored extensive documentation (knowledge-base articles, guides, runbooks) and served as a trusted technical consultant to client stakeholders.

Ricoh USA, Inc.

- Ran a schedule of executive meetings to plan revenue, satisfaction, and cost strategy, building a team that consistently met or exceeded quarterly and annual goals.
- Directly supported and trained a user base of over 35,000 students, faculty, and staff.
- Consistently met and exceeded the one-hour service-call response SLA.

Selected Projects

dnsweaver

Open-source Go tool that keeps DNS records in sync with your infrastructure across Technitium, Pi-hole, AdGuard, and Cloudflare. Multi-provider, split-horizon, self-hosted. Full CI/CD and semantic versioning. Owner and maintainer: design, provider selection, releases and CI.

Kubernetes Homelab

9-node Talos Linux cluster under ArgoCD GitOps running roughly fifty applications, synced from a self-hosted GitLab with secret scanning gating the merge. OpenTofu and Ansible provisioning; GPU sharing via time-slicing; Prometheus and Alertmanager paging; runbooks and post-incident records per service. Migrated from Docker Swarm without losing service.

Multi-agent operations harness (private)

Governance for dozens of concurrent AI agent sessions on one estate: a scoped GitLab identity per harness, an MCP gateway with a read-only lane and a separate write token approved per call, scheduled jobs that start in shadow until promoted, and every session recording its work in GitLab issues. Direction, rules and review are mine; agents implement.

OPNsense (upstream)

Two contributions merged into the OPNsense firewall platform six years apart: a maximum packet length option for traffic shaper rules (core, 2020), and BGP maximum-paths for ECMP multipath with its documentation (FRR plugin, 2026, shipped in plugin 1.52). PHP on Phalcon.

maxfieldallison.com

This site: self-hosted on the Kubernetes cluster as the primary origin with a Cloudflare Pages failover mirror and an edge Worker that switches between them automatically.

Skills

Cloud: Microsoft Azure, Azure Front Door, Application Gateway, Load Balancing, Cloud Migration

Platform: Kubernetes, Talos Linux, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, Infrastructure as Code, Observability (Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager)

Automation & Code: Terraform / OpenTofu, Ansible, CI/CD, Linux, Python (scripting), REST APIs & Webhooks

Architecture & Delivery: Solution Architecture, AI Agent Orchestration & Governance, ServiceNow (CHG / RITM / SCTASK), Requirements & Sizing, Stakeholder Management, Customer-Facing Consulting

Other: Network Security, Firewalls, Leadership, SQL Server

Education & Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals
- Seven enterprise product certifications — Kofax Equitrac, AutoStore, RightFax, ControlSuite
- Two contributions merged upstream into the OPNsense firewall platform, six years apart

Recognition

- Specialist of the Quarter (x2), Specialist of the Year, Ricoh STAR Award